新题 1：

Claim: In any situation, the best way to persuade other people is to present them with facts and statistics rather than with emotional arguments.

Reason: Facts are objective, so they are more persuasive than subjective appeals.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim and the reason on which that claim is based.

Sample：

Persuading others is important in our lives and work. Some people believe that it is more effective to reason than to emote in any situation where they want to persuade someone. They believe that facts are objective and therefore deserve to be more convincing. In my view, although the above argument is reasinable, facts are not necessarily more persuasive in all cases.

First, I acknowledge that the facts are objective and therefore more persuasive. To explain this, we can look at the definition. The purpose of "persuasion" is to convince others of what you are saying, and when they cannot refute you, they have to believe what you are saying. A "fact", as opposed to an "objective", is something that cannot be disproved or refuted. For example, the results of experiments, data, observations, etc.. In contrast, other things are considered "subjective" because they are inherently open to refutation, such as reasoning, speculation, conjecture, etc. Subjective opinions have room for refutation, while objective facts have no room for refutation, so natural facts are more convincing than subjective ones. Also, "facts" are often unequivocal statements, while "subjective" is often vague or even emotional statements. For example, when you want to convince your employee not to be late, it is more effective to tell him "you are late ten times this month" than "why are you always late this month."

Therefore, in some cases, objective facts and figures are a better way to convince people than subjective reasoning. For example, in the academic field, especially in the natural sciences, speculation without solid evidence is often untenable, while facts and data obtained through experiments, once presented, others will naturally

accept your conclusions. For instance, when the theory of relativity was first proposed, no matter how renowned Einstein was in the scientific community, no matter how sound the reasoning behind it was, because there was no experimental data to support it, there were always people who did not recognize the theory of relativity. However, in a subsequent total solar eclipse, the relativistic phenomenon was observed, and thus relativity was confirmed. Likewise, in the judicial field, especially in countries that have adopted the principle of "suspicion without guilt", as long as there is no objective evidence, no matter how sound the prosecution gives reasons, the suspect cannot be convicted. For example, in the famous O.J. Simpson case, no matter how strong the motive for the murder was, or even the evidence given by the prosecution, the suspect was acquitted simply because of the possibility of falsification of this evidence.

However, objective facts are not exactly the same as being able to convince others. This is because although the "facts" are objective and irrefutable, convincing others depends on their acceptance. If you present facts that are difficult to understand and beyond the other person's perception, then a simpler, more intuitive, more acceptable subjective inspiration is more convincing. For example, imagine you are trying to persuade your companion to leave a crowded place with you. If you say, "There are two people standing in this place per square meter," the other person may not know what you are trying to say. But if you directly say "this place is too crowded, let's go", your companion will be more easily persuaded by you.

So, not all situations are the best way to convince someone with facts and figures. In cases where facts and figures cannot be given, we obviously have to take a reasoned approach to convince others. For example, why should the country develop space exploration? The benefits of space exploration cannot be measured in terms of data, but the national pride that comes from successful space exploration and the emotional reasons that help foster a love of science among young people can directly persuade the public to accept the country's spending vast amounts of money on space exploration.

In summary, while facts are objective, they are not always more persuasive than subjective emotions.

新题 2

Some people believe that success in creative fields, such as painting, fiction writing, and filmmaking, primarily requires hard work and perseverance. Others believe that such success mainly requires innate talents that cannot be learned.

Write a response in which you discuss which view more closely aligns with your own position and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should address both of the views presented.

Sample:

What are the most important qualities to be successful in the creative fields? Some people believe that talent is key to success in creative fields. However, as I see it, hard work and perseverance are more crucial.

First of all, we should not deny that to be successful in the creative field, talent plays a prominent role. To fully understand this viewpoint, we can start from the definition of "creative". The reason why something is considered "creative" is that it has not been done before. Since no one has ever done it before, there exists no experience and method, so it is impossible to learn. Thus if you want to do something "creative", talent is essential. For example, Picasso's cubist painting style completely broke the traditional principle of perspective. This kind of unprecedented creativity is inseparable from talent. The second reason is that there is no quantifiable indicator to measure whether a work of art is "creative". It often depends on the personal feelings of the evaluator. Hard work, by contrast, requires a direction and an implementable methodology. Therefore, the results created by "hard work" often follow the path of the previous ones, and thus can hardly be called "creative". For example, if I try to imitate a painter's painting, my result can be stunning, and even my painting can be sold for a high price. But unfortunately, this cannot be called "creative".

That said, we should not overlook the importance of hard work and perseverance. This is because creativity can be stimulated by acquired effort. It is true that creativity is something that has not been done before, but nothing can be created from nowhere, and many ideas emerge because of the great accumulation of writers and painters before. And this accumulation cannot do without hard work. For example, in the aforementioned Picasso's case, his cubism is indeed unprecedented. However, it is because of Picasso's deep

understanding of traditional perspective that he was able to break the traditional perspective relationship in his cubist paintings.

Moreover, if one wants to achieve success in the secular sense, hard work is more valuable. Let's look at the definition of "success". The debate between talent and hard work depends on what kind of success one wants to achieve. If you want to start a new genre that will be known for centuries, then talent is more important than hard work. That's because in a world where there is already a wealth of results in every field, most things have been done by others. So if you want to make a breakthrough, you can only rely on talent. However, if you want to achieve worldly success, such as fame, money, and popularity, then talent plays a less important role, and more depends on the effort. Hollywood blockbusters, for example, are already an industry which follows a mature production flow. For Hollywood directors to make blockbusters, it is enough to follow the formula to write the script and hire popular actors. The key to the success of these works could hardly be said to be talent, and they are not even creative, but have won worldly success. For the director, all he puts in is the hard work of shooting and coordinating various processes. Another example is that, to be a famous pianist in contemporary times, one just needs to have the acquired hard work of practicing the works of predecessors, such as Bach or Mozart, to become a great piano performer. Talent will play a role in this, but the difference is that talented people can become pianists at a young age because their fingers are more flexible and their musical sense is more sensitive, while those who lack talent will eventually become pianists if they work hard, just a few years later.

In summary, talent is certainly important in the creative field, but hard work can inspire creativity, and hard work is more important than talent for achieving success in the secular sense.

新题 3

In business, education, and government, it is always appropriate to remain skeptical of new leaders until those leaders show that they are worthy of trust.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your

position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.

Sample:

Should people remain skeptical of new leaders until they demonstrate their reliability? Some people hold that they should remain skeptical. But I think in most cases, it is wise not to always be skeptical.

Admittedly, it is beneficial to maintain an appropriate level of skepticism about leaders. This is because we need to be able to think independently at all times and not follow the crowd. This is especially true in democratically elected governments. In the United States, for example, the president is elected by the people. The president elected can be an experienced professional politician, like Joe Biden, but he or she could also start from being an actor, like Reagan, or a businessman, like Trump. No matter how successful they were in their previous fields, presidents in the latter category are rookies in the presidency. So these staffers in the administration could potentially be in serious trouble if they consistently take orders from the new president. Imagine if Fauci, the U.S. epidemiologist, had not questioned Trump's level of competence in facing the Covid 19 pandemic; the current state of the epidemic in the United States might have been even worse.

That said, we cannot always doubt new leaders either, because that would hinder the functioning of the organization. Still using Trump as an example, imagine if every member of the administration was skeptical when he first took office, this would not only stifle the introduction of wrong policies, but also more correct policies, and the stable functioning of the government would be seriously affected.

In addition, there is a paradox in this proposal. That is the relationship between the new leader demonstrating trustworthy qualities and the trust of the people. If people are always skeptical of new leaders, how will they be able to unleash their talents and demonstrate their trustworthiness? It is true that people are skeptical of new leaders in order to gain a higher level of security. People need to see the trustworthiness of a new leader to be reassured. However, within the limits of control, people should trust the leader more than anything else. First, this is because, in most cases, the leader has demonstrated strong performance in the previous job to become the leader of the new job. Second, in many positions, the perception is that the cost of waiting until the leader

demonstrates trustworthy characteristics is greater than the cost incurred by the new leader making mistakes. This is especially true in areas where the impact is far-reaching. Take education for example. Imagine the president of a university wants to introduce a new policy to improve the employment rate of students after graduation. The effect of this policy will not be evaluated until the students have graduated in four years, and every year the policy is in place, there is a year of delay for students. If people want to wait for new leaders to demonstrate their abilities, there are bound to be students who will be negatively impacted by the lack of this new policy in the process.

In conclusion, while we should be skeptical of leaders, we should not always be skeptical of incoming leaders in order to keep the organization running smoothly and to give new leaders the opportunity to show what they can do reliably.

新题 4

Claim: Group assignments that students must work together to complete should replace a substantial amount of traditional lecture-based instruction in college and university courses.

Reason: It is vital for students to gain experience collaborating with peers to study a topic and to achieve a common goal.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim and the reason on which that claim is based.

Sample：

It is an obvious task for schools to develop students' ability to collaborate, but it is debatable whether group assignment should replace lecture-based instruction in order to cultivate student collaboration.

First, I acknowledge that the ability to cooperate is essential. This is because modern industrial society is becoming more and more complex and people's division of labor is becoming more and more elaborate, so cooperation between different divisions of labor is very important in order for each complex system to function smoothly.

For example, a small cell phone requires cooperation and collaboration between designers and engineers to create a machine with both technological elegancies and obeys the laws of physics and engineering. Since the division of labor and cooperation is so important in the future of work, schools should begin developing the ability and awareness for collaboration while people still are students. On the one hand, this is because the school itself is a place where people get training, and society is a place where students apply those abilities. On the other hand, school is a better place than society to develop students' collaborative skills. This is because school is a place where students can develop collaborative skills starting with the most basic tasks, such as group assignments. But when they get to the workplace, the collaboration students face will be more complex and sophisticated. Without basic training in cooperation in school, it is not easy to adapt to a more complex partnership when they go to the workplace. In summary, collaboration skills are worth developing in school.

That said, schools should not be able to substantially replace teacher instruction in order to develop collaboration skills. First, this is because the teacher's class is an important way to transmit knowledge, and students gain knowledge most efficiently in the classroom. This is why, whether in ancient Greece or ancient China, the teacher's lecture-based instruction was the most widely-used means of teaching. That is why we should keep the teacher's lectures. Especially for the more theoretical subjects, for example, teacher lectures can hardly be replaced by other means, such as basic subjects like mathematics and theoretical physics. These subjects involve a great deal of theoretical knowledge, and students need to have a teacher lecture to introduce these theories. This knowledge is unknown and difficult to understand until students hear it from a teacher. Therefore, no matter how much students work together on a task, they will not be able to grasp this knowledge and will have to rely on the teacher's lecture.

Furthermore, the claim that collaborative student work should replace traditional teacher instruction relies on the false assumption that collaboration and teacher instruction are mutually exclusive. Based on such an assumption, people believe that class time must be sacrificed for collaboration. However, the two are not incompatible. We can recall the group work we did in college. Each one was done within the framework of the professor's guidance. Students can still develop the ability to work together under the guidance of a professor.

Finally, developing collaborative skills doesn't have to take place in the classroom. Many off-campus activities and hands-on work are opportunities to build collaborative skills, and these situations do not, in and of themselves, replace lectures.

In summary, while I agree that collaborative skills should be developed in school, we should not overlook the significance of teacher instruction. Teacher instruction is an efficient way to transfer knowledge and is not mutually exclusive to the development of students' collaborative skills. Therefore, teacher instruction should not be replaced by group assignments.